Why Street Fighter's New Cammy Looks So Familiar

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If Cammy from Street Fighter looks familiar, there is a good reason. The actor playing her in the new 2026 film has already had a busy career in action movies.

Cammy first appeared in Super Street Fighter II: The New Challengers in 1993, a follow-up to the 1991 arcade game Street Fighter II. Fans know her by her long blonde braids and her **beret**. In the game's story, she belongs to a **special forces** group called Delta Red.

In the 1994 movie, Cammy was played by Australian pop star Kylie Minogue. In director Kitao Sakurai's new 2026 film, she is played by Thai-born Australian actor Mel Jarnson.

Jarnson is no stranger to game-based action films. She played the **villain** Nitara in the 2021 film Mortal Kombat, her first major film role. She did not return for Mortal Kombat II. Before that, she had small parts in short films and in the Australian shows Harrow and Between Two Worlds.

After Mortal Kombat, more work followed. In 2022, she appeared in the **thriller** Blacklight, starring Liam Neeson. In 2024, she played a main character in Chuck Russell's **remake** of Witchboard, which the article says received some good reviews. Early in 2026, she took a co-leading role in Killer Whale, alongside Virginia Gardner.

In the 2026 film, Cammy is a **villain** working for M. Bison, played by David Dastmalchian, ruler of Shadaloo in the story. She does not have a very large role, partly because the film has so many characters that most appear in smaller storylines or as fighting opponents.

As of the article's writing, Jarnson is also scheduled to appear in the upcoming film Empire City, playing Leda. Cammy may not be her biggest role, but it is one of her most visible.

Word Treasure

beret -- A soft, round, flat hat with no brim.

special forces -- A small military group trained for difficult or special jobs.

villain -- A bad character in a story or film who causes trouble for others.

remake -- A new version of an older film or game.

thriller -- A film or story that is exciting and full of suspense.

Background you need

Street Fighter is a fighting game in which different fighters face each other in matches.

Cammy is one of its fighters, known for her braids and beret.

A film based on a game turns those game characters into people played by actors, with new stories built around them.

When a film has many characters, each one may get only a small part of the story, which is why a familiar face can still have a smaller role.

Break it down

LEAD: Cammy looks familiar because the actor playing her in the new 2026 film has had a busy career in action movies.

KEY EVENT: Mel Jarnson plays Cammy in director Kitao Sakurai's new 2026 Street Fighter film.

+- WHO: Mel Jarnson as Cammy; David Dastmalchian as M. Bison
+- WHEN: Cammy first appeared in 1993; the new film is from 2026
+- WHAT: Cammy is a villain working for M. Bison, in a smaller role

EVIDENCE: Jarnson played the villain Nitara in the 2021 film Mortal Kombat, then appeared in Blacklight, Witchboard, and Killer Whale.

OPEN QUESTION: Jarnson is also scheduled to appear in the upcoming film Empire City, playing Leda.

Why it matters

Casting shows how actors build careers role by role, and how a familiar game character can look new again when a different actor takes the part.

Test what you remember

1. Who plays Cammy in director Kitao Sakurai's new 2026 film?

(A) Kylie Minogue
(B) Liam Neeson
(C) Mel Jarnson
(D) Virginia Gardner

2. When did Cammy first appear?

(A) In the 2021 film Mortal Kombat
(B) In the 1994 movie
(C) In Super Street Fighter II: The New Challengers in 1993
(D) In the upcoming film Empire City

3. What was Mel Jarnson's first major film role?

(A) A main character in Witchboard
(B) Cammy in Street Fighter
(C) Leda in Empire City
(D) The villain Nitara in the 2021 film Mortal Kombat

4. Who played Cammy in the 1994 movie?

(A) Virginia Gardner
(B) Australian pop star Kylie Minogue
(C) Mel Jarnson
(D) David Dastmalchian

5. In the 2026 film, for whom does Cammy work as a villain?

(A) Delta Red
(B) Virginia Gardner
(C) Chuck Russell
(D) M. Bison

6. Why does Cammy not have a very large role in the 2026 film?

(A) She is only in short films
(B) She is scheduled for Empire City instead
(C) The film has so many characters that most appear in smaller storylines or as fighting opponents
(D) She did not return for Mortal Kombat II

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: D 4: B 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):